

D017

School Law

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A district school board that has served for twelve years adopts a policy that students with disabilities will not be allowed on field trips, to save on staffing. The policy passed unanimously and was covered by the local newspaper. What is the policy's legal status?

- A. It is valid, because the board voted unanimously.
- B. It is valid until the state legislature repeals it.
- C. It is unenforceable, because it conflicts with federal disability law, which ranks above district policy.
- D. It is valid because boards have final authority over all school matters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A high school sophomore on the honor roll wears a black armband to class to protest a national policy. A few teachers dislike it, but classes run normally. The school recently won a state award for civic education. May the principal discipline the student?

- A. No, because the school won a civic education award.
- B. Yes; students have no free-speech rights at school.
- C. Yes, because some teachers disliked it.
- D. No; silent personal expression without substantial disruption is protected.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which situation may a principal most clearly limit student speech?

- A. A student expressing an unpopular opinion during an open class discussion.
- B. A student wearing a political button that causes no disruption.
- C. Any student speech the principal finds offensive.
- D. Editing an article in the school-sponsored newspaper produced in a journalism class, for legitimate teaching reasons.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An assistant principal with a background in counseling gets a credible report from two students that a classmate has a vape pen in her backpack. The classmate has perfect attendance. May the assistant principal search the backpack?

- A. Yes, and a strip search is also allowed if the backpack is empty.
- B. No; school searches require probable cause and a warrant.
- C. Yes; the credible report gives reasonable suspicion, and searching the backpack fits the item sought.
- D. No, because the student has perfect attendance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school searched a student based on reasonable suspicion of hidden ibuprofen and required the student to remove clothing. A court would most likely find the search:

- A. Unreasonable in scope, because the intrusion was excessive for a low-danger item with no sign it was hidden on the body.
- B. Unreasonable, because schools need a warrant to search.
- C. Reasonable, because reasonable suspicion existed at the start.
- D. Reasonable, because schools may search students any way they choose.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A principal at a school with a newly renovated gym plans a three-day suspension for a student accused of vandalizing the locker room. The student's older brother was suspended last year. What process is required before the suspension?

- A. Review the brother's record to confirm a pattern.
- B. Tell the student the charges and evidence and give the student a chance to explain.
- C. A formal hearing with attorneys and witnesses.
- D. No process, since the suspension is short.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A reporter from a respected regional newspaper calls the school office asking for a student's grades and discipline history for a story. The student is 15 and plays varsity soccer. What should the office do?

- A. Release the grades but not the discipline history.
- B. Decline to release the records without written parental consent.
- C. Release them, because the newspaper is reputable.
- D. Release them, since athletes' records are public.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student turns 18 and is still in high school. Who now holds the FERPA rights to inspect and consent to disclosure of the student's records?

- A. The parents, until graduation.
- B. The student.
- C. No one; records become public at 18.
- D. The principal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

At a graduation ceremony in the district's new stadium, the principal plans to invite a local clergy member to lead the audience in prayer, noting that most families in the community are religious. Is this permissible?

- A. No, and students may never pray anywhere on campus.
- B. Yes, because most families are religious.
- C. No; school-sponsored prayer at an official school event violates the Establishment Clause.
- D. Yes, if attendance at graduation is voluntary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students ask to form a Bible study club that meets before school. The school allows other non-curricular clubs such as chess and anime. What must the school do?

- A.** Allow the club on the same terms as other non-curricular clubs.
- B.** Allow it only if a teacher leads the Bible study.
- C.** Deny it, because religious clubs violate the Establishment Clause.
- D.** Deny it unless every student joins.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A veteran science teacher who has won district awards writes a letter to the local newspaper, on her own time, criticizing the school board's budget cuts to arts programs. The principal wants to discipline her. Which analysis applies?

- A.** Her speech is unprotected, because she is a public employee.
- B.** Her speech is unprotected, because it was part of her job duties.
- C.** Her speech is protected because of her awards.
- D.** Her speech is likely protected, because she spoke as a citizen on public concern, unless it seriously disrupted school operations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

During recess on a new playground, a teacher on duty leaves to take a personal phone call for 20 minutes. A student falls from a climbing structure that had a broken rail reported the week before, and breaks an arm. The teacher is well liked by parents. Which elements of negligence are most clearly present?

- A.** Duty, breach, causation and damages are all likely present.
- B.** Only damages, since the student was hurt.
- C.** None, because playgrounds always carry some risk.
- D.** None, because parents like the teacher.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A district school board ~~that has served for twelve years~~ adopts a policy that students with disabilities will not be allowed on field trips, to save on staffing. ~~The policy passed unanimously and was covered by the local newspaper.~~ What is the policy's legal status?

Target word: legal status of a local policy **Decides:** Federal disability law overrides conflicting local policy.

A	Camouflage	Vote margin does not override federal law.
B	Inverted operation	Federal law already controls; no state action is needed.
C	Correct	Local policy must comply with higher law.
D	Absolute language	Board authority sits below state and federal law.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A high school sophomore ~~on the honor roll~~ wears a black armband to class to protest a national policy. A few teachers dislike it, but classes run normally. ~~The school recently won a state award for civic education.~~ May the principal discipline the student?

Target word: can speech be restricted **Decides:** No substantial disruption occurred or could reasonably be forecast.

A	Camouflage	Right answer for the wrong reason; the award does not decide it.
B	Absolute language	Students keep their rights at school.
C	Adjacent category	Discomfort or disagreement is not substantial disruption.
D	Correct	Tinker protects student speech unless it substantially disrupts or invades others' rights.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

In which situation may a principal most clearly limit student speech?

Target word: when restriction is allowed **Decides:** School-sponsored speech may be limited for legitimate teaching reasons.

A	Adjacent category	Unpopularity is not disruption.
B	Inverted operation	That is protected personal expression.
C	Absolute language	Offense alone is not the standard.
D	Correct	School-sponsored speech can be limited for legitimate pedagogical concerns.

4. Answer C Concept 3

An assistant principal ~~with a background in counseling~~ gets a credible report from two students that a classmate has a vape pen in her backpack. ~~The classmate has perfect attendance.~~ May the assistant principal search the backpack?

Target word: is the search allowed **Decides:** A credible tip gives reasonable suspicion; a backpack search is reasonable in scope.

A	Absolute language	The scope must stay reasonable; a strip search for a vape pen is excessive.
B	Adjacent category	That is the police standard, not the school standard.
C	Correct	Justified at inception and reasonable in scope.
D	Camouflage	Attendance has nothing to do with suspicion.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A school searched a student based on reasonable suspicion of hidden ibuprofen and required the student to remove clothing. A court would most likely find the search:

Target word: judge the scope **Decides:** The intrusion was excessive for the item and danger involved.

A	Correct	Scope must match the item, the danger and the evidence.
B	Adjacent category	Right result, wrong standard.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the second test: reasonable scope.
D	Absolute language	Searches have legal limits.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A principal at a school ~~with a newly renovated gym~~ plans a three-day suspension for a student accused of vandalizing the locker room. ~~The student's older brother was suspended last year.~~ What process is required before the suspension?

Target word: required due process **Decides:** Short suspension: notice and a chance to respond.

A	Camouflage	A sibling's record has no bearing on this student's due process.
B	Correct	Notice and an informal hearing meet due process for 10 days or less.
C	Absolute language	That level of process is for longer exclusions such as expulsion.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out notice and the chance to be heard.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A reporter from a ~~respected regional~~ newspaper calls the school office asking for a student's grades and discipline history for a story. The student is 15 ~~and plays varsity soccer~~. What should the office do?

Target word: response under FERPA **Decides:** Education records need consent before disclosure; no exception applies to reporters.

A	Dropped element	Grades are also protected education records.
B	Correct	FERPA bars disclosure of education records without consent unless an exception applies.
C	Camouflage	Reputation is not a FERPA exception.
D	Adjacent category	Sports participation may be directory information, but grades and discipline are not.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A student turns 18 and is still in high school. Who now holds the FERPA rights to inspect and consent to disclosure of the student's records?

Target word: who holds the rights **Decides:** Rights transfer to the student at 18.

A	Inverted operation	Rights move at 18, not at graduation (though schools may still share with parents of tax dependents).
B	Correct	FERPA rights transfer to an eligible student at 18.
C	Absolute language	Records stay protected.
D	Confusion set	The school holds records but not the rights over them.

9. Answer C Concept 6

At a graduation ceremony ~~in the district's new stadium~~, the principal plans to invite a local clergy member to lead the audience in prayer, noting that most families in the community are religious. Is this permissible?

Target word: school-sponsored prayer **Decides:** The school is organizing and endorsing the prayer at an official event.

A	Absolute language	Private, student-initiated prayer is protected.
B	Camouflage	Majority approval does not change the constitutional rule.
C	Correct	The school may not sponsor or endorse religious exercise.
D	Adjacent category	Voluntary attendance does not cure school sponsorship.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Students ask to form a Bible study club that meets before school. The school allows other non-curricular clubs such as chess and anime. What must the school do?

Target word: student religious club access **Decides:** Equal access for non-curricular clubs.

A	Correct	Equal access applies once a school allows non-curricular clubs.
B	Adjacent category	Staff may monitor but not lead; teacher leadership would suggest school sponsorship.
C	Inverted operation	Student-led clubs on equal terms are not school endorsement.
D	Absolute language	Participation must be voluntary.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A ~~veteran~~ science teacher ~~who has won district awards~~ writes a letter to the local newspaper, on her own time, criticizing the school board's budget cuts to arts programs. The principal wants to discipline her. Which analysis applies?

Target word: is the speech protected **Decides:** She spoke as a citizen on a matter of public concern.

A	Absolute language	Public employees keep some speech rights.
B	Confusion set	Writing to a newspaper on her own time is not a job duty.
C	Camouflage	Awards do not decide protection.
D	Correct	Citizen speech on public concern is weighed against the school's interests.

12. Answer A Concept 8

During recess on a new playground, a teacher on duty leaves to take a personal phone call for 20 minutes. A student falls from a climbing structure that had a broken rail reported the week before, and breaks an arm. ~~The teacher is well liked by parents.~~ Which elements of negligence are most clearly present?

Target word: negligence elements **Decides:** Duty to supervise, breach by leaving, a known hazard, and an injury.

A	Correct	Leaving duty near a known hazard is a foreseeable-risk breach that plausibly caused the injury.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out duty, breach and causation, which the facts also support.
C	Absolute language	Some risk does not excuse a breach of reasonable care.
D	Camouflage	Popularity does not affect liability.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	11	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The hierarchy of law	The U.S. Constitution and valid federal law override conflicting state law, and state law overrides conflicting district policy and school rules; local practice must fit every level above it.	Assuming a local board policy stands because the board adopted it.	A district or school rule that conflicts with a higher law.
2	Student speech (Tinker and its limits)	Students keep free-speech rights at school; personal expression may be restricted only if it would substantially disrupt school or invade others' rights, while school-sponsored speech may be limited for legitimate teaching reasons.	Banning expression because it is unpopular or makes adults uncomfortable.	A student message, shirt or post and a question about discipline.
3	Student searches: reasonable suspicion	School officials may search a student with reasonable suspicion that the search will turn up evidence of a rule or law violation; the search must be justified at its start and reasonable in scope given the item and the intrusion.	Requiring probable cause, or thinking any suspicion justifies any search.	A tip or observation followed by a search of a bag, locker or person.
4	Due process for short suspensions	Before a suspension of 10 days or less, a student must get notice of the charges and a chance to tell their side; an informal hearing is enough, and removal may come first if there is immediate danger.	Thinking short suspensions need no process, or that a formal hearing with lawyers is required.	A suspension of a few days and a question about required steps.
5	FERPA and education records	Parents (or students once they turn 18 or attend college) may inspect education records, and records generally may not be disclosed without consent, except for listed exceptions such as school officials with a legitimate educational interest.	Sharing records with anyone who asks politely, or refusing parents access.	A request to see or share a student's record.
6	Religion in public schools	The Establishment Clause bars school-sponsored prayer or religious endorsement, but students may pray privately and form religious clubs on the same terms as other non-curricular clubs.	Banning all student religious expression, or allowing school-led prayer because most families approve.	Prayer, a religious club or religious material and who is sponsoring it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
7	Employee speech	A public employee speaking as a citizen on a matter of public concern has some protection, weighed against the school's interest in operations; speech made as part of official job duties is not protected by the First Amendment.	Assuming all employee speech is protected, or none is.	Whether the employee spoke as a citizen or as part of the job.
8	Negligence and duty of supervision	Negligence requires a duty, a breach of reasonable care, the breach causing the injury, and actual harm; foreseeable risks increase the care required.	Assuming a school is liable for every injury, or never liable.	An injury during school supervision and a question about liability.

Course scope (public description): School Law prepares candidates to understand the appropriate application of laws, rights, policies, and regulations to promote student success. The course emphasizes the importance of understanding the history of and relationship between federal and state laws, legal decisions, local education policies, and practices at the local school level to ensure compliance. The course further focuses on understanding the legal rights and protections provided for all students, including those with disabilities, as well as school staff. It also addresses curriculum and instruction that help stakeholders understand the possible effects these rights may have on administrative decisions. Candidates are also provided the opportunity to demonstrate their capability to evaluate legal consequences of administrative decisions.